JAMES CHRISTOPHER MILLER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Engineer with 6 years of hands-on experience building and scaling backend systems for high-traffic platforms. I've spent the last three years leading architectural decisions and mentoring junior engineers while maintaining hands-on involvement in critical infrastructure projects. My background spans cloud infrastructure, distributed systems, and backend development, with a particular focus on Go and Python. I'm based in Birmingham and actively contribute to open-source projects in my spare time.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer - Platform Infrastructure

Vertex Innovations Ltd

www.vertexinnovations.io

Birmingham, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led the redesign of our core microservices architecture, reducing latency by 40% and improving system reliability from 98.5% to 99.9% uptime. Established engineering standards and code review practices that were adopted across all 12 engineering teams. Mentored 4 junior engineers through promotion cycles and guided them on complex system design problems. Owned the migration of our legacy monolith to Kubernetes, managing the transition of 150+ services with zero production incidents.

Senior Backend Engineer

TechFlow Solutions

www.techflow.net

Birmingham, United Kingdom

July 2019 - February 2022

Designed and implemented a real-time data processing pipeline handling 2 million events per second using Go and Apache Kafka. Reduced database query times by 65% through careful indexing strategy and query optimization across PostgreSQL and Redis. Contributed to infrastructure-as-code initiative using Terraform, bringing deployment time down from 45 minutes to under 5 minutes. Developed comprehensive monitoring and alerting systems using Prometheus and Grafana, catching production issues before customer impact.

Backend Engineer

Synapse Digital Services Ltd

www.synapseservices.co

Solihull, United Kingdom

September 2018 - June 2019

Built and maintained REST APIs serving 10 million monthly active users using Python and Django framework. Implemented caching strategies that reduced server load by 50% and improved response times from 800ms to 120ms average. Collaborated with DevOps team to containerize applications and set up CI/CD pipelines with

Jenkins and Docker. Participated in on-call rotation and resolved production incidents with average MTTR of 15 minutes.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2018

Grade: 2:1

SKILLS

Backend Development: Go, Python, Java

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Cloud Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform

Containerization: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm

DevOps and Infrastructure: Terraform, Ansible, CI/CD pipelines, Jenkins

Messaging Systems: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

API Design: REST, gRPC, GraphQL

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

jcmiller/distributed-cache-go

A distributed caching library in Go with consistent hashing and automatic rebalancing. Used internally at previous employers and featured in several technical blogs.

jcmiller/kafka-stream-processor

Python library for processing streaming data from Apache Kafka with built-in backpressure handling and exactly-once semantics.

jcmiller/postgres-performance-toolkit

Collection of SQL analysis tools and monitoring scripts for PostgreSQL performance optimization and bottleneck identification.

jcmiller/microservices-patterns

Reference implementations of common microservices patterns including circuit breaker, saga pattern, and event sourcing in Go.